THE HEIGHT MATRIX MODULO p AND THE p-ADIC DIGITS OF THE HEIGHT AT SPLIT ANOMALOUS PRIMES

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Abstract. Let $E/\mathbb{Q}$ be an elliptic curve and $p \geq 5$ a prime of good ordinary reduction with $\#\widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p) = p$ and $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)[p] \neq 0$. In a previous paper we showed that, under mild hypotheses, the cyclotomic p-adic height matrix of E is then p-integral and has rank at most two modulo p. Here we determine it further. Modulo p the matrix is given by two local constants and two homomorphisms χ, γ defined by the first two layers of the filtration of $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. The second p-adic digit of the height involves the Fermat quotient of the denominator of the point, so the description in terms of the filtration does not continue. We show that all digits are truncations of a single identity involving two Iwasawa logarithms and an even power series in the formal logarithm whose coefficients are explicit invariants of E; this determines, in terms of their valuations, the digit at which each invariant appears, and it shows that $\min(v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p), k)$ in rank one is a function of k layers of the filtration and $k-1$ digits of one Fermat quotient, and of no smaller set of data. A non-degeneracy condition used in these results, $v_p(\phi_p'(x(T))) = 1$ at the points of order p, is proved for all $p \geq 5$. Finally, a point deep in the formal filtration has large height; this gives an archimedean sufficient condition for the regulator to be a unit in rank two, which accounts, in expectation, for the observed shortfall of non-unit regulators relative to the frequency $1/p$ in our computations.

1. Introduction

Let $E/\mathbb{Q}$ be an elliptic curve given by a global minimal Weierstrass equation, $p \geq 5$ a prime of good ordinary reduction, and $\Lambda = E(\mathbb{Q})/E(\mathbb{Q})_{\mathrm{tors}}$, of rank r. Let h_p be the cyclotomic p-adic height and Reg_p the corresponding regulator. Suppose that p is anomalous, $\#\widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p) = p$, that $p \nmid n := \prod_\ell c_\ell$, and that ($\iota$) the reduction map $\Lambda \to \widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p)$ is surjective. In [P1] we proved that the height matrix M is p-integral if and only if E is *split at* p, that is, $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)[p] \neq 0$, and that in the split case $\overline{M} = M \bmod p$ vanishes on $\ker\chi \times \ker\chi$, where $\chi\colon \Lambda \to \mathbb{F}_p$ is the discrete logarithm of the reduction. This paper studies the split case in more detail.

1.1. The matrix modulo p.

In the split case $E(\mathbb{Q}_p) = D \oplus E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ with $D = E(\mathbb{Q}_p)[p]$. Writing a point as $\chi(Q)T_0 + R$ with $T_0 \in D$ and $R \in E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$, put $\gamma(Q) = t(R)/p \bmod p$. Then χ and γ are homomorphisms $E(\mathbb{Z}_p) \to \mathbb{F}_p$, and $\ker\chi \cap \ker\gamma = E_2(\mathbb{Q}_p)$.

Theorem 1.1 (Theorem 3.4)**.** *There are constants $\lambda_{T,1}, B_0 \in \mathbb{F}_p$, depending only on $E/\mathbb{Q}_p$ and on the choice of T_0, with $B_0 \neq 0$, such that for all $P, R \in \Lambda$*

$$\overline{M}(P,R) = 2\lambda_{T,1}\,\chi(P)\chi(R) + B_0\big(\chi(P)\gamma(R) + \gamma(P)\chi(R)\big).$$

So $\overline{M}$ has rank two exactly when $(\chi,\gamma)\colon \Lambda \to \mathbb{F}_p^2$ is surjective, and in rank $r \geq 3$ the regulator has valuation exactly $r-2$ if and only if $p^{-1}h_p$ is non-degenerate modulo p on $(\Lambda \cap E_2(\mathbb{Q}_p))/p\Lambda$ (Corollary 3.5).

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1.2. **The second digit and beyond.** One might expect $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) \geq 2$ to be governed in the same way by the image of Λ in $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)/E_3(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. This is false. For P with $\chi(P) \neq 0$, write $x(nP) = a/d'^2$ in lowest terms and let Θ be the second Fermat quotient of $\phi_p(x(nP))$ (Section 4). Then

$$n^2 h_p(P) \equiv (1+p)\,\Theta + 2p\,q_p(d') \pmod{p^2}$$

(Theorem 4.1). The Fermat quotient $q_p(d')$ of the denominator is not determined by the image of P in $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)$.

All digits are described by one identity. Put $P'' = pnP$, $F = (d'^{p-1} - 1)/p$ and let z be the formal logarithm. Then

$$n^2 h_p(P) = \frac{1}{1-p}\Big[p^{-2}\log(1+p^2\Theta) + 2\log(1+pF)\Big] + p^{-2}\mathcal{L}(z(P'')),$$

where $\mathcal{L}(z) = \log\big(x\,\sigma_p(t)^2\big)$ is an *even* power series in z whose coefficients are invariants of E: $\mu_2 = -c$, $\mu_4 = -b_4/12$, $\mu_6 = -b_2b_4/360 - b_6/30$, with $c = (b_2 - E_2(E,\omega))/12$ (Theorem 5.1, Proposition 5.2). The congruences for the individual digits are truncations of this identity. In particular the normalisation of σ_p, through E_2, is visible only at the third digit, and the next local invariant b_4 only at the seventh. In rank one, $\min(v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p), k)$ is a function of the layers $\gamma, \gamma_2, \ldots, \gamma_k$ of the filtration and of F mod p^{k-1}, and of no smaller set of data (Theorem 6.4).

1.3. **A non-degeneracy.** Several of these statements need $v_p(\phi_p'(x(T))) = 1$ at the points T of order p. We prove that this holds for every $p \geq 5$ and every ordinary curve over $\bar{\mathbb{F}}_p$ (Theorem 7.5). The proof identifies a resultant of division polynomials modulo p with a power of the discriminant times an explicit non-zero constant.

1.4. **An archimedean input.** A rational point in $E_k(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ has naive height at least $2k\log p$. Hence, if some non-zero point of $\Lambda \cap E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ has canonical height below $4\log p + \beta(E)$, where $\beta(E)$ is a lower bound for the local heights away from p, then (χ, γ) is surjective and, in rank two, Reg_p is a unit (Proposition 8.3). In our computations on curves of rank two this condition accounts, in expectation, for the whole observed shortfall of non-unit regulators relative to the frequency $1/p$ (Section 8).

Conventions. Results are proved on paper unless stated otherwise. The arithmetic steps are formalised in Lean 4 (Appendix A); statements marked *[computation]* were checked with PARI/GP on curves from Cremona's tables and are not proved. This paper and [P1] are a revision of an earlier draft by the author [Draft]; Appendix B lists the corresponding labels.

Related work. The nearest published work we know to Proposition 5.2 is [BG], on the universal p-adic sigma function. Theorem 5.1 and Propositions 7.2 and 7.4 may well be known.

2. Setting

We use the notation of [P1]. For $P \in E(\mathbb{Q}) \smallsetminus \{O\}$ write $P = (\alpha/d^2, \beta/d^3)$ in lowest terms; $t = -x/y$; $E_k(\mathbb{Q}_p) = \{v_p(t) \geq k\}$; $\log = \log_p$ is Iwasawa's logarithm. The height is $h_p(P) = 2\log(\sigma_p(P)/d(P))$ for P reducing to O at p and to non-singular points at the bad primes, extended quadratically; $\sigma_p \in t\mathbb{Z}_p[[t]]$ is the Mazur–Tate sigma function [MT91], normalised by

$$x(t) + c = -\frac{d}{\omega}\Big(\frac{1}{\sigma}\frac{d\sigma}{\omega}\Big), \qquad c = \frac{b_2 - E_2(E,\omega)}{12},$$

with $E_2(E,\omega)$ the value of the p-adic weight-two Eisenstein series. Division polynomials satisfy $x(mQ) = \phi_m/\psi_m^2$, $y(mQ) = \omega_m/\psi_m^3$; modulo p, $\phi_p \equiv f(x^p)$ and $\psi_p \equiv g(x^p)$.

For $u \in \mathbb{Z}_p^\times$, $q_p(u) = (u^{p-1}-1)/p \bmod p$, and if $q_p(u) = 0$ we put

$$Q_2(u) = \frac{u^{p-1}-1}{p^2} \in \mathbb{Z}_p, \qquad q^{(2)}(u) = Q_2(u) \bmod p.$$

Throughout, unless stated otherwise:

(H) $p \geq 5$ is of good ordinary reduction, $\#\widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p) = p$, $p \nmid n$, (ι) holds, and $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)[p] \neq 0$.

We write $D = E(\mathbb{Q}_p)[p]$, fix $T_0 \in D$ whose reduction G generates $\widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p)$, and let χ be the discrete logarithm of the reduction with respect to G. For a class $\bar{x} \in \widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p) \smallsetminus \{O\}$ let $T(\bar{x}) \in D$ be the unique point above it.

2.1. **Results from** [P1]**.** We use: (a) for P reducing to O and satisfying the condition at bad primes, $h_p(P) \in 2p\mathbb{Z}_p$; (b) the decomposition $h_p(P) = 2\log(\sigma_p(t)/t) + 2\log(\alpha/\beta)$; (c) for P' with reduction of order p, $v_p(t(pP')) \geq 2$ in the split case; (d) $\lambda(\bar{x}) = \frac{1}{2}q_p(\phi_p(x)) = 0$ for all lifts x of all $\bar{x} \neq O$ in the split case, so $\phi_p(x)^{p-1} \in 1+p^2\mathbb{Z}_p$; (e) $\overline{M}$ vanishes on $\ker\chi \times \ker\chi$, and $h_p(e_1) \equiv 2\lambda^{(2)}/n^2 \pmod p$ for $\chi(e_1) \neq 0$, where $\lambda^{(2)} = \frac{1}{2}q^{(2)}(\phi_p(x(ne_1)))$; (f) for $p \nmid m$ and $Q \in E(\mathbb{Z}_p)$ with non-zero reduction, $q^{(2)}(\phi_p(x(mQ))) = m^2 q^{(2)}(\phi_p(x(Q)))$, proved as [P1, Prop. 6.1]: there $\delta \in p^4\mathbb{Z}_p$ since $e \geq 2$, and the factor $\psi_m(Q)^{2p^2}$, a p^2-th power of a unit, has trivial $q^{(2)}$. We also use the formal-part bound $v_p(\log(\sigma_p(t)/t)) \geq \min(e + v_p(a_1), 2e)$, $e = v_p(t)$.

3. The height matrix modulo p

3.1. **Two homomorphisms.** Since $E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ is torsion-free, $D \cap E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p) = 0$, and $D \to \widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p)$ is an isomorphism. Hence $E(\mathbb{Q}_p) = D \oplus E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. For $Q \in E(\mathbb{Z}_p)$ write $Q = \chi(Q)T_0 + R$ with $R \in E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ and put

$$\gamma(Q) = t(R)/p \bmod p.$$

Then χ, γ are homomorphisms, $\gamma(T_0) = 0$, and $\ker\chi \cap \ker\gamma = E_2(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. More generally, write $t(R)/p = \gamma + p\gamma_2 + p^2\gamma_3 + \cdots$; we call γ_k the k-th layer.

Lemma 3.1. *Let $P \in E(\mathbb{Z}_p)$ have non-zero reduction and $R \in E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ with $t = t(R)$. Then $x(P+R) \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[t]]$ and*

$$x(P+R) = x(P) + c_1(P)\,t + O(t^2), \qquad c_1(P) = 2y(P) + a_1x(P) + a_3 \in \mathbb{Z}_p^\times.$$

Proof. Translation by P is an automorphism of the smooth model over $\mathbb{Z}_p$ taking O to a point with non-zero reduction, so $x \circ \tau_P \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[t]]$. The invariant differential $\omega = dx/(2y + a_1x + a_3) = (1 + a_1t + \cdots)dt$ is translation-invariant, so the coefficient of t is $c_1(P)$. It is a unit because $\#\widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p) = p$ is odd, so $\widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p)$ has no point of order two. □

3.2. **The second Fermat quotient under a change of lift.** Put $G_\phi = \phi_p'/p$ and $H_\phi = G_\phi'$; both are polynomials with coefficients in $\mathbb{Z}[a_1, \ldots, a_6]$. For a lift x_0 of $\bar{x} \neq O$ put $\Theta(x_0) = Q_2(\phi_p(x_0))$; by (d) this is defined.

Proposition 3.2. *For $k \in \mathbb{Z}_p$, with $u = \phi_p(x_0)$,*

$$\Theta(x_0 + pk) \equiv \Theta(x_0) + (p-1)\,k\,\frac{G_\phi(x_0)}{u} - p\,k^2\frac{H_\phi(x_0)}{2u} \pmod{p^2}.$$

In particular $\lambda^{(2)}(x_0 + pk) = \lambda^{(2)}(x_0) + k\,s(\bar{x})$ with $s(\bar{x}) = -G_\phi(\bar{x})/(2\phi_p(\bar{x})) \in \mathbb{F}_p$.

Proof. Taylor expansion gives $\phi_p(x_0 + pk) \equiv u + p^2kG_\phi(x_0) + p^3k^2H_\phi(x_0)/2 \pmod{p^4}$. Call the correction ε; then $p^2 \mid \varepsilon$ and $(u+\varepsilon)^{p-1} \equiv u^{p-1}(1 + (p-1)\varepsilon/u) \pmod{p^4}$. Divide by p^2. □

By Theorem 7.5 below, $s(\bar{x}) \neq 0$ for every $\bar{x}$; so $\lambda^{(2)}$, unlike λ, depends on the lift.

3.3. **Two local identities and the matrix.** For $\bar{x} \neq O$ put $\lambda_T(\bar{x}) = \lambda^{(2)}(x(T(\bar{x})))$, and let $B_0 = s(G)\, c_1(T_0)$ and $\lambda_{T,1} = \lambda_T(G)$.

Proposition 3.3. *For every $\bar{x} \in \widetilde{E}(\mathbb{F}_p) \smallsetminus \{O\}$, with $m = \chi(\bar{x})$,*

$$s(\bar{x})\, c_1(T(\bar{x})) = B_0\, m, \qquad \lambda_T(\bar{x}) = \lambda_{T,1}\, m^2.$$

Proof. Let $L_2(Q) = \lambda^{(2)}(x(Q))$ for $Q \in E(\mathbb{Z}_p)$ with non-zero reduction. By (f), $L_2(mQ) = m^2 L_2(Q)$. By Lemma 3.1, $x(Q) \equiv x(T) + p\, c_1(T)\gamma(Q) \pmod{p^2}$ with $T = \chi(Q)T_0$, and by Proposition 3.2,

$$L_2(Q) = \lambda_T(\bar{x}) + s(\bar{x})\, c_1(T)\, \gamma(Q).$$

On the coset $\chi = 1$, γ takes all values in $\mathbb{F}_p$. Replacing Q by mQ multiplies χ and γ by m; comparing constant and linear terms in $\gamma(Q)$ of $L_2(mQ) = m^2 L_2(Q)$ gives both identities. □

Theorem 3.4. *Under* (H)*, for all $P, R \in \Lambda$,*

$$h_p(P) \equiv 2\lambda_{T,1}\chi(P)^2 + 2B_0\, \chi(P)\gamma(P) \pmod{p},$$

$$\overline{M}(P,R) = 2\lambda_{T,1}\chi(P)\chi(R) + B_0\big(\chi(P)\gamma(R) + \gamma(P)\chi(R)\big).$$

The constants depend only on $E/\mathbb{Q}_p$ and T_0; the Tamagawa product n does not appear.

Proof. For $\chi(P) \neq 0$, (e) of §2.1 gives $h_p(P) \equiv 2L_2(nP)/n^2$. By the proof of Proposition 3.3 and Proposition 3.3 itself,

$$L_2(nP) = \lambda_{T,1} n^2 \chi(P)^2 + B_0\, n\chi(P)\, n\gamma(P).$$

For $\chi(P) = 0$ both sides vanish modulo p by (a). Polarise. □

Corollary 3.5. (i) $\operatorname{rank} \overline{M} = 2$ *if and only if* $(\chi, \gamma)\colon \Lambda \to \mathbb{F}_p^2$ *is surjective.*

(ii) *If $r = 1$, then $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) \geq 1$ if and only if $\gamma(e_1)/\chi(e_1) = -\lambda_{T,1}/B_0$.*

(iii) *Suppose (χ, γ) is surjective, take a basis $e_1, \dots, e_r$ of $\Lambda \otimes \mathbb{Z}_p$ with $\chi(e_1) = 1$, $\chi(e_2) = 0 \neq \gamma(e_2)$ and $e_3, \dots, e_r \in E_2(\mathbb{Q}_p)$, and let $\widehat{C}$ be the Gram matrix of $p^{-1}h_p$ on $e_3, \dots, e_r$. Then $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) = r - 2$ if and only if $\det \widehat{C} \not\equiv 0 \pmod{p}$.*

Proof. (i) and (ii) are linear algebra over $\mathbb{F}_p$. For (iii), such a basis exists because (χ, γ) factors through $\Lambda/p\Lambda$ and $\ker\chi \cap \ker\gamma = E_2(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. By Theorem 3.4, M has the shape $\begin{pmatrix} a & b & 0 \\ b & pC_{22} & p* \\ 0 & p* & p\widehat{C} \end{pmatrix}$ with b a unit, and the Schur complement of the leading 2×2 block is $p\widehat{C}$ modulo p^2. □

Thus the deficit $r - 2$ comes from the two layers χ and γ, and what remains in rank $r \geq 3$ is a non-degeneracy of $p^{-1}h_p$ one layer deeper. [Computation: the exact formula $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) = (r-2) + v_p(\det \widehat{C})$ fails in one of the 48 boxes of rank three and conductor at most 400000 tested, 310329*c*1 at $p = 5$.]

4. The second digit

Theorem 4.1. *Under* (H)*, let $P \in \Lambda$ with $\chi(P) \neq 0$, put $P' = nP$, and write $x(P') = a/d'^2$ in lowest terms. Then*

$$n^2 h_p(P) \equiv (1+p)\, \Theta(x(P')) + 2p\, q_p(d') \pmod{p^2}.$$

Proof. Take a model with $p \mid a_1$; put $P'' = pP'$, $e = v_p(t(P'')) \geq 2$, $\phi = \phi_p(x(P'))$, $\psi = \psi_p(x(P'))$, $\omega = \omega_p(P')$. Four terms are needed modulo p^4.

(1) *Formal part.* $2\log(\sigma_p(t)/t) \equiv a_1 t(P'') \pmod{p^4}$, since the next term has valuation at least $2e \geq 4$.

(2) *Weierstrass equation.* Multiplying it at P'' by ψ^6, all terms of $\omega^2-\phi^3$ other than $-a_1\phi\omega\psi$ have valuation at least $2e\ge 4$, so $\omega^2\equiv\phi^3-a_1\phi\omega\psi \pmod{p^4}$. Writing $\phi^{p-1}=1+p^2\Theta$ and $\omega^{p-1}=1+p^2B$, this gives $Q_2(\phi/\omega)\equiv -\Theta/2-a_1\omega\psi/(2p^2\phi^2) \pmod{p^2}$.

(3) *Denominator.* As in [P1], $\alpha/\beta=\pm(\phi/\omega)d'^{-p^2}$, and $-p^2\log d'\equiv p^3q_p(d') \pmod{p^4}$.

(4) *Logarithm.* For u with $q_p(u)=0$, $\log u\equiv -p^2(1+p)Q_2(u) \pmod{p^4}$.

Adding, $h_p(P'')\equiv a_1t(P'')+(1+p)(p^2\Theta+a_1\omega\psi/\phi^2)+2p^3q_p(d') \pmod{p^4}$. Since $t(P'')=-\phi\psi/\omega$,

$$a_1t(P'')+a_1\omega\psi/\phi^2=a_1\psi(\omega^2-\phi^3)/(\phi^2\omega),$$

which has valuation at least $2v_p(a_1)+2e\ge 6$ by (2), and $p\,a_1\omega\psi/\phi^2$ has valuation at least 4. Hence $h_p(P'')\equiv(1+p)p^2\Theta+2p^3q_p(d') \pmod{p^4}$, and $h_p(P'')=p^2n^2h_p(P)$. □

Modulo p this is (e). The term $q_p(d')$ depends on the global denominator, and two points with the same image in $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)/E_k(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ for every k can have different $q_p(d')$. Thus no homomorphism $\Lambda\cap E_2\to E_2/E_3$ determines the second digit. The local term, on the other hand, is governed by one p-adic number:

Proposition 4.2. *Fix $\bar{x}\neq O$ and $T=T(\bar{x})$. The map $\delta\mapsto\Theta(x(T)+p\delta)$ is a bijective isometry of $\mathbb{Z}_p$. In particular it has a unique zero δ_*, and $v_p(\Theta(x(T)+p\delta))=v_p(\delta-\delta_*)$.*

Proof. By Proposition 3.2, modulo p this map is $\delta\mapsto\Theta(x(T))+2s\delta$ with $s\neq 0$ (Theorem 7.5), and its derivative is a unit everywhere. Hensel's lemma applied in each residue class gives the claim. □

Corollary 4.3. *Let $r=1$ and $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p)\ge 1$, so that $p\mid\Theta(x(P'))$. Then $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p)\ge 2$ if and only if $\Theta(x(P'))/p+2q_p(d')\equiv 0 \pmod{p}$.*

Remark 4.4. Under $x\mapsto u^2x$ with $p\nmid u$, ϕ_p is multiplied by u^{2p^2}, so $\Theta\mapsto\Theta+2p\,q_p(u) \pmod{p^2}$, while d' is unchanged if $\gcd(u,d')=1$. So Theorem 4.1 refers to a model minimal at p; the term $q_p(d')$ is paired with the normalisation of the model.

5. A closed form for all digits

Keep the notation of Theorem 4.1 and put

$$\Theta=Q_2(\phi_p(x(P'))),\qquad F=\frac{d'^{p-1}-1}{p}\in\mathbb{Z},\qquad z=\log_E(t(P'')),$$

where $\log_E$ is the formal logarithm with $d\log_E=\omega$; so $v_p(z)=e$. Let $X=x(P'')$, $Y=y(P'')$, and

$$R=\frac{a_2}{X}+\frac{a_4}{X^2}+\frac{a_6}{X^3}-\frac{a_1Y}{X^2}-\frac{a_3Y}{X^3},$$

so that $\omega_p(P')^2=\phi_p(x(P'))^3(1+R)$.

Theorem 5.1. *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 4.1,*

$$n^2h_p(P)=\frac{1}{1-p}\Big[p^{-2}\log(1+p^2\Theta)+2\log(1+pF)\Big]+p^{-2}\mathcal{L}(z),$$

where

$$\mathcal{L}(z)=\log\big(X\,\sigma_p(t(P''))^2\big)=2\log\frac{\sigma_p(t)}{t}-\log(1+R).$$

Proof. From the proof of Theorem 4.1, $p^2n^2h_p(P)=h_p(P'')=2\log(\sigma_p(t)/t)+2\log(\phi/\omega)-2p^2\log d'$. Since $\omega^2=\phi^3(1+R)$, $2\log(\phi/\omega)=-\log\phi-\log(1+R)$. For a unit u, $\log u=(p-1)^{-1}\log(u^{p-1})$, so $-\log\phi-2p^2\log d'=-(p-1)^{-1}[\log(1+p^2\Theta)+2p^2\log(1+pF)]$. This gives the formula with the second expression for $\mathcal{L}$. For the first, $t^2=X^2/Y^2=\psi^2/(\phi(1+R))=1/(X(1+R))$, so $X\sigma_p(t)^2=(\sigma_p(t)/t)^2/(1+R)$. □

Proposition 5.2. *As a power series in z, $\mathcal{L}(z) = \sum_{m\geq 1} \mu_{2m} z^{2m}$ has no odd terms, and*

$$\mu_2 = -c, \qquad \mu_4 = -\frac{b_4}{12}, \qquad \mu_6 = -\frac{b_2 b_4}{360} - \frac{b_6}{30}.$$

Moreover $\mu_{2m} \in \mathbb{Z}[1/(2m+2)!][b_2, b_4, b_6, E_2]$, E_2 occurs only in μ_2, and $v_p(\mu_{2m}) \geq -v_p((2m)!)$; in particular $c \in \mathbb{Z}_p$.

Proof. The defining equation of σ_p is $(d/dz)^2 \log \sigma_p = -(x + c)$, and

$$x + b_2/12 = \wp(z) = z^{-2} + \sum_{k\geq 1} \pi_k z^{2k}$$

with $\pi_1 = c_4/240$, $\pi_2 = c_6/6048$. Put $a = -b_2/12$. Then $(d/dz)^2 \log(\sigma_p/z) = -(a + c) - \sum_k \pi_k z^{2k}$ is even, and integrating twice,

$$2 \log \frac{\sigma_p(z)}{z} = -(a + c)z^2 - 2 \sum_{k\geq 1} \frac{\pi_k z^{2k+2}}{(2k + 1)(2k + 2)}.$$

Also $x(z)z^2 = 1 + az^2 + \pi_1 z^4 + \pi_2 z^6 + \cdots$ is even, so $\mathcal{L} = \log(xz^2) + 2\log(\sigma_p/z)$ is even. Comparing coefficients: at z^2, $a - (a + c) = -c$. At z^4, $\pi_1 - a^2/2 - \pi_1/6 = (c_4 - b_2^2)/288 = -b_4/12$, using $c_4 = b_2^2 - 24b_4$; here E_2 cancels. At z^6, $\pi_2 - a\pi_1 + a^3/3 - \pi_2/15$; substituting c_4 and $c_6 = -b_2^3 + 36b_2b_4 - 216b_6$, the terms in b_2^3 cancel and $\mu_6 = -b_2b_4/360 - b_6/30$. The coefficient of z^{2m} involves π_k only for $k \leq m - 1$, and $\pi_k \in \mathbb{Z}[1/(2k + 3)!][c_4, c_6]$ by the recursion for the Laurent coefficients of $\wp$; the other denominators are the factors $(2k+1)(2k+2)$ and the $j \leq m$ from the j-th term of $\log(1+\cdots)$. So only primes $\leq 2m+1$ occur.

For the valuation, let $\mathcal{H}$ be the set of series $\sum_n a_n z^n/n!$ with $a_n \in \mathbb{Z}_p$. It is a ring, stable under d/dz and $\int_0^z$; so for $w \in \mathcal{H}$ with $w(0) = 0$ also $w^n/n! = \int_0^z w'\, w^{n-1}/(n-1)!$, $g(w)$ for $g \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[T]]$, and $\log(1 + w) = \sum_{n\geq 1}(-1)^{n-1}(n-1)!\, w^n/n!$ lie in $\mathcal{H}$. The parameter t lies in $\mathcal{H}$: $dt/dz = (1 + a_1 t + \cdots)^{-1} \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[t]]$, so by induction every derivative of t at $z = 0$ is in $\mathbb{Z}_p$. As xt^2 and $\sigma_p(t)/t$ lie in $1 + t\mathbb{Z}_p[[t]]$, $\mathcal{L} = \log\bigl(xt^2(\sigma_p(t)/t)^2\bigr) \in \mathcal{H}$, that is, $(2m)!\, \mu_{2m} \in \mathbb{Z}_p$. □

The denominators are not bounded independently of m: μ_6 has a 5, μ_8 a 7, and μ_{14} an 11 and a 13.

Proposition 5.3. *In Theorem 5.1, the j-th term of $p^{-2}\log(1+p^2\Theta)$ has valuation at least $2j - 2 - v_p(j)$, the j-th term of $2\log(1+pF)$ has valuation at least $j - v_p(j)$, with equality in both when Θ and F are units, and $p^{-2}\mu_{2m} z^{2m}$ has valuation $2me - 2 + v_p(\mu_{2m})$. A term of valuation v first affects $n^2 h_p(P)$ modulo p^{v+1}. For $e = 2$, μ_2 appears at the third digit, μ_4 at the seventh, and μ_6 at the tenth if $p = 5$ and the eleventh if $p \geq 7$.*

Proof. Term-by-term valuation of the logarithm series, using $v_p(z) = e$; the last sentence uses $v_5(\mu_6) = -1$ and $v_p(\mu_6) \geq 0$ for $p \geq 7$. The series converges because $v_p(\mu_{2m}) \geq -v_p((2m)!) > -2m/(p-1)$ (Proposition 5.2). □

Lemma 5.4. *$z^2 - 1/x(z) = -(b_2/12)z^4 + O(z^6)$ with only even powers. Hence $p^{-2}(z(P'')^2 - 1/x(P''))$ has valuation at least $4e - 2 \geq 6$, and $1/x(P'')$ may replace $z(P'')^2$ through the sixth digit but not at the seventh.*

Proof. Invert $x(z)z^2 = 1 + az^2 + \cdots$ with $a = -b_2/12$. □

Truncating Theorem 5.1 gives explicit congruences. With c as above:

Corollary 5.5. *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 4.1,*

$$n^2 h_p(P) \equiv (1+p+p^2)\Theta + 2p(1+p)F - p^2F^2 - \tfrac{p^2}{2}\Theta^2 - \frac{c}{p^2 x(P'')} \pmod{p^3},$$

$$n^2 h_p(P) \equiv (1+p+p^2+p^3)\Theta + 2p(1+p+p^2)F - p^2(1+p)F^2 + \tfrac{2}{3}p^3F^3 - \tfrac{p^2}{2}(1+p)\Theta^2 - \frac{c}{p^2 x(P'')} \pmod{p^4}.$$

Proof. Expand the three series of Theorem 5.1 using $(1-p)^{-1} \equiv 1+p+p^2+p^3 \pmod{p^4}$ and Proposition 5.3: only $\mu_2 z^2$ contributes from $\mathcal{L}$, and by Lemma 5.4 it may be written $-c/x(P'')$. Every term on the right is invariant under $(x,y) \mapsto (x, y+sx)$. □

Remark 5.6 (Computation.). The truncations at the fifth, sixth and seventh digits, written out from Proposition 5.3, hold in all 648 boxes tested (conductor at most 12000, $p \in \{5,7\}$, split, $e \geq 2$). At the seventh digit b_4 enters through $\mu_4 z^4$, and $1/x(P'')$ no longer serves in place of z^2. The identity of Theorem 5.1, truncated, was checked to the tenth digit; $\mathcal{L}$ needs no odd powers at any depth reached.

6. The minimal data at each digit

Let $T = \chi(P)T_0$ and $t_1 = t(nP - T) \in p\mathbb{Z}_p$, with $t_1/p = \gamma + p\gamma_2 + p^2\gamma_3 + \cdots$.

Proposition 6.1. *$P'' = p(nP-T)$, so $z(P'') = p\log_E(t_1)$ and $e = 1 + v_p(t_1)$. Moreover $t(P'') \equiv p^2\gamma \pmod{p^3}$, so $e = 2$ if and only if $\gamma \neq 0$, and $c/(p^4 x(P'')) \equiv c\gamma^2 \pmod{p}$.*

Proof. T and nP have the same reduction and $pT = O$. The formal logarithm satisfies $\log_E([p]t) = p\log_E(t)$. For the second statement, ordinary reduction gives height one, so the coefficients of $[p](t) = pt + \sum_{i\geq 2} c_i t^i$ are divisible by p for $2 \leq i < p$; with $t_1 = p\gamma + \cdots$ this gives $[p](t_1) \equiv p^2\gamma \pmod{p^3}$. Finally $1/x = t^2(1+O(t))$. □

So $\mathcal{L}(z(P''))$ is a function of t_1, that is of the layers, and of the invariants μ_{2m}; it adds no global datum.

Theorem 6.2. *For $t_1 \in p\mathbb{Z}_p$ and $j \geq 1$, with Θ viewed as a function of t_1 through $x(T \oplus t_1)$,*

$$v_p\big(\Theta(t_1 + p^j) - \Theta(t_1)\big) = j - 1.$$

Proof. By Lemma 3.1, the x-coordinate moves by exactly p^j. Since $\phi_p \equiv f(x^p)$, all divided derivatives $\phi_p^{(k)}/k!$ with $1 \leq k \leq p-1$ are divisible by p; so ϕ_p moves by $pG_\phi(x_0)\Delta + p\Delta^2 B + \Delta^p C$ with $v_p(\Delta) = j$, which has valuation exactly $j+1$ because $G_\phi(x(T))$ is a unit (Theorem 7.5). Raising the unit $\phi_p(x_0)$ to the power $p-1$ preserves this valuation, and dividing by p^2 gives $j-1$. □

Proposition 6.3. *Let $t_1' = t_1 + p^j$ with $j \geq 1$ and $z' = z(t_1')$. Then $v_p(z'-z) = 1+j$ and*

$$v_p\big(p^{-2}(\mathcal{L}(z') - \mathcal{L}(z))\big) \geq j+1.$$

Hence, with F fixed, the two sides of Theorem 5.1 at t_1 and t_1' differ at valuation exactly $j-1$.

Proof. The Taylor expansion of $\log_E$ at t_1 has k-th term of valuation at least $kj - v_p(k)$, and the first term has valuation exactly j; multiply by p. For $m \geq 1$, $z'^{2m} - z^{2m}$ has valuation at least $(1+j) + (2m-1)\min(e, 1+j) \geq (1+j) + 2(2m-1)$. Since $v_p(\mu_{2m}) \geq -v_p((2m)!) \geq 4 - 4m$ (Proposition 5.2), all terms of $p^{-2}\Delta\mathcal{L}$ have valuation at least $j+1$. The Θ-side moves at valuation $j-1$ by Theorem 6.2, and the factor $(1-p)^{-1}$ and the bracket are units. □

Theorem 6.4. *Assume* (H) *and* $r = 1$. *Fix* E, p, T_0 *and the local invariants. Then* $\min(v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p), k)$ *is a function of*

$$(\chi, \gamma, \gamma_2, \dots, \gamma_k) \quad \textit{and} \quad F \bmod p^{k-1},$$

and of no smaller set of data: changing γ_k, *or the* $(k-1)$*-st digit of* F, *alone can change* $\min(v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p), k)$.

Here $\min(v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p), k)$ is read as a function on the parameters $t_1 \bmod p^{k+1}$ and $F \bmod p^{k-1}$ of Theorem 5.1, with E, p, T_0 and the local invariants fixed; the necessity is a statement about this function.

Proof. Sufficiency. By Theorem 5.1, $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) \geq k$ is a condition on $\Theta \bmod p^k$, on $F \bmod p^{k-1}$ and on $p^{-2}\mathcal{L}$ modulo p^k. By Theorem 6.2, $\Theta \bmod p^k$ depends on $t_1 \bmod p^{k+1}$, and by Proposition 6.1 so does $p^{-2}\mathcal{L}$ modulo p^k.

Necessity. Changing γ_k alone changes the right-hand side at valuation exactly $k-1$ by Proposition 6.3, so at most one of the two values is divisible by p^k. Changing F by p^{k-2} changes $2\log(1+pF)$ at valuation exactly $k-1$, and nothing else moves. □

For $k = 2, 3, 4$ the criteria are explicit. With $\Theta = p\Theta_1$, $S = (\Theta_1 + 2F)/p$ and $W = c/(p^4 x(P'')) \equiv c\gamma^2$:

Corollary 6.5. *Let* $r = 1$.

(i) *If* $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) \geq 2$, *then* $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) \geq 3$ *if and only if* $S \equiv F^2 + W \pmod p$.
(ii) *If* $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) \geq 3$ *and* $S - F^2 - W = pU$, *then* $v_p(\mathrm{Reg}_p) \geq 4$ *if and only if* $6U + 6(S - F^2) + 4F^3 \equiv 0 \pmod p$.

Proof. Substitute into Corollary 5.5. □

Remark 6.6. On the rational points of a single curve the two kinds of data are related. Along $P + p^a\Lambda$ the digit of F at p^{a-1} is determined by χ, $n^2 h_p(P) \bmod p$ and the homomorphism $Z \mapsto t(pnZ)/p^2 \bmod p$ [Draft, Prop. 21], and $F \bmod p^k$ is determined by $n^2 h_p(P) \bmod p^{k+1}$ and $t_1 \bmod p^{k+2}$, by inverting Theorem 5.1 [Draft, Prop. 22]. Nevertheless both kinds of necessity in Theorem 6.4 are realised by rational points: [computation] on the rank-two curve $4407a1$ at $p = 5$, read point by point.

7. The non-degeneracy

We prove that $s(\bar{x}) \neq 0$, equivalently $v_p(\phi_p'(x(T))) = 1$, for all $p \geq 5$. Work over $\bar{\mathbb{F}}_p$ with $\widetilde{E}\colon y^2 = u(x) = x^3 + a_4 x + a_6$ and $\Delta_0 = 4a_4^3 + 27a_6^2$, weights $2, 4, 6$ for x, a_4, a_6. Write $\psi_p \equiv \Psi(x^p)$ with $\deg \Psi = n_p = (p-1)/2$ and leading coefficient the Hasse invariant A; $h = \Psi/A$; $\phi_p \equiv \Phi(x^p)$; $w^{(p)}(X) = X^3 + a_4^p X + a_6^p$. Then h is the kernel polynomial of the Verschiebung V and $\Phi/(A^2 h^2)$ is its x-coordinate. Let $K = \psi_p'/p \bmod p$ and $S_1 = (\phi_p - 4uK^2)/\psi_p$; by Lemma 7.3 the non-degeneracy at $\bar{x}$ is equivalent to $S_1(\bar{x}) \neq 0$. Let

$$\mathcal{D} = -6a_6\,\partial_{a_4} + \tfrac{4}{3}a_4^2\,\partial_{a_6},$$

which raises weight by 2, kills Δ_0, and acts on q-expansions of forms of weight k as $-q\,d/dq + \frac{k}{12}E_2$, hence as $-q\,d/dq$ when $p \mid k$.

Lemma 7.1. *Let* $\lambda\colon E' \to E$ *be separable of odd degree with kernel polynomial* h, $x \circ \lambda = P/h^2$, $y \circ \lambda = y'\Omega/h^3$, $\lambda^*\omega_E = c\,\omega_{E'}$. *At every simple root* ξ *of* h *with* $P(\xi) \neq 0$,

$$c^2 P(\xi) = 4u_{E'}(\xi)h'(\xi)^2, \qquad c^2 P'(\xi) = 2\big[u_{E'}(h')^2\big]'(\xi).$$

Proof. Clearing denominators in $\omega_E = dx/2y$ gives $P'h - 2Ph' = c\Omega$ and $u_{E'}\Omega^2 = P^3 + a_4 P h^4 + a_6 h^6$. Evaluate at ξ, and differentiate once. □

The numerator P has leading coefficient c^{-2}. For $\lambda = V$ we have $P = \Phi/A^2$ with Φ monic, so $c^2 = A^2$, and the lemma gives $\Phi(\xi) = 4w^{(p)}(\xi)h'(\xi)^2$ and $\Phi'(\xi) = 2[w^{(p)}(h')^2]'(\xi)$ at the roots of h.

Proposition 7.2. *$A \cdot (\psi_p'/p) = u^{(p-1)/2}\,(d\Psi/dX)(x^p)$ in $\mathbb{F}_p[a_4, a_6][x]$.*

Proof. It suffices to check this at ordinary points. Lift $\widetilde{E}$ to E over a complete discrete valuation ring with $v(p) = 1$. Let $C = \widehat{E}[p]$ be the canonical subgroup [Kat73]. Its non-zero points have $v(x) = -2/(p-1)$, so $\psi_p = \lambda MN$ with $M = p \cdot (\text{kernel polynomial of } C)$, $M \equiv A_0$ a constant modulo p, and N the factor for the other points. Write $\pi\colon E \to E/C$ and $\hat{\pi}$ with $\hat{\pi}\circ\pi = [p]$, $x\circ\pi = P_\pi/M^2$, $y\circ\pi = y\,\Omega_\pi/M^3$ and $c_\pi = p\varpi$; then $x\circ\pi \equiv x^p$ and $\Omega_\pi/M^3 \equiv u^{n_p}$ modulo p. Up to a unit, $N = M^{2n_p}h^*(x\circ\pi)$ with $h^* \equiv h$. Differentiating and using $2n_p + 1 = p$,

$$K = \lambda M^{2n_p}M'h^*(x\circ\pi) + \lambda\varpi M^{2n_p-2}(h^*)'(x\circ\pi)\,\Omega_\pi,$$

Modulo p the first term vanishes since $M' \equiv 0$, and the second is $\kappa\,u^{n_p}h'(x^p)$ with $\kappa \in \mathbb{F}^\times$; comparing leading coefficients gives $\kappa = 1$. □

Lemma 7.3. *Let $\widetilde{E}$ be ordinary and $\bar{x}$ a root of $\psi_p \bmod p$. Then $\psi_p \bmod p$ divides $\phi_p - 4uK^2$, $K(\bar{x}) \neq 0$, and*

$$G_\phi(\bar{x}) = -K(\bar{x})\,S_1(\bar{x}).$$

Hence the non-degeneracy at $\bar{x}$ is equivalent to $S_1(\bar{x}) \neq 0$.

Proof. Lift $\widetilde{E}$ and write $\psi_p = \lambda MN$ as in the proof of Proposition 7.2; we use the letters K and G_ϕ also for the integral polynomials ψ_p'/p and ϕ_p'/p. The roots ξ of N are simple and integral, and they reduce to the roots of $\psi_p \bmod p$. As $N \bmod p$ is a polynomial in x^p, $N' = pN_1$ with N_1 integral. Lemma 7.1 for $[p]$, with $c = p$, kernel polynomial ψ_p/p and $P = \phi_p/p^2$, gives $\phi_p(\xi) = 4u(\xi)K(\xi)^2$ and $\phi_p'(\xi) = 2(uK^2)'(\xi)$. By the first, $F = \phi_p - 4uK^2$ is NF_2 with F_2 integral, so $S_1 = F_2/(\lambda A_0) \bmod p$. By the second, $F'(\xi) = -pG_\phi(\xi)$. Differentiating $F = NF_2$ and $\psi_p = \lambda MN$ at ξ gives $-pG_\phi(\xi) = pN_1(\xi)F_2(\xi)$ and $pK(\xi) = \lambda M(\xi)\,pN_1(\xi)$. Dividing by p and reducing, with $M \equiv A_0$, gives $G_\phi(\bar{x}) = -N_1(\bar{x})F_2(\bar{x})$ and $K(\bar{x}) = \lambda A_0 N_1(\bar{x})$, hence the identity. Finally $K(\bar{x}) \neq 0$ by Proposition 7.2, since $u(\bar{x}) \neq 0$ and h has simple roots. □

Proposition 7.4. *$\phi_p \equiv 4u(\psi_p'/p)^2 + \mathcal{D}(\psi_p^2) \pmod p$; equivalently $S_1 = 2\mathcal{D}\psi_p$.*

Proof. By Proposition 7.2 the claim is $\Phi - 4w^{(p)}(h')^2 = 2A(\mathcal{D}A)h^2 + 2A^2h\,\mathcal{D}h$. By Lemma 7.1 for V the left side vanishes on the roots of h, and it has degree at most $p-1$ since $4n_p^2 \equiv 1$; write it as hC_1. Differentiating and using the second identity of Lemma 7.1, $C_1(\xi) = -2[w^{(p)}(h')^2]'(\xi)/h'(\xi)$ at each root ξ of h. As $\deg C_1 \le n_p$ and h is monic of degree n_p, the identity amounts to

$$\text{(R) } \big[w^{(p)}(h')^2\big]' + A^2h'\,\mathcal{D}h \equiv 0 \pmod h, \qquad \text{(L) } [X^{p-1}]\big(\Phi - 4w^{(p)}(h')^2\big) = 2A\,\mathcal{D}A.$$

At a root ξ_i of h, (R) reads $A^2\mathcal{D}\xi_i = w^{(p)\prime}(\xi_i) + 4w^{(p)}(\xi_i)\sum_{j\neq i}(\xi_i - \xi_j)^{-1}$. Both sides of the claim are weight-homogeneous, and q-expansion is injective on each weight [Ser73, SwD73], so it suffices to check (R) and (L) on the Tate curve [ATAEC, Ch. V], where $A \equiv 1$ and V is the isogeny $E_{q^p} \to E_q$. Put $Q = q^p$, let X_Q, Y_Q be the coordinates of E_Q in the short model, so that $dX_Q/2Y_Q = dW/W$ and $Y_Q^2 = w^{(p)}(X_Q)$, and let $\xi_i = X_Q(q^i)$, $\eta_i = Y_Q(q^i)$ for $1 \le i \le n_p$.

(a) Since $p\,Q\,\partial_Q = 0$, $q\,d\xi_i/dq = 2i\eta_i$; as ξ_i has weight $2p$, $\mathcal{D}\xi_i = -2i\eta_i$.

(b) The product formula for $x_Q(W_1) - x_Q(W_2)$ gives

$$H(W) = h(X_Q(W)) = C'W^{n_p}\theta_q(W)\theta_Q(W)^{-p},$$

where $\theta_q(W) = (1-W)\prod_{m\ge1}(1-q^mW)(1-q^m/W)$.

(c) With $D = W\,d/dW$, $DH/H = n_p + D\log\theta_q(W)$ in characteristic p. At $W = q^i(1+s)$ the term $m = i$ of $D\log\theta_q$ is $1/s$ and the other terms sum to $-(i-1)$ at $s = 0$, so $DH/H = 1/s + \kappa + O(s)$ with $\kappa = n_p + 1 - i$, and $D^2H/DH = 2\kappa - 1 \equiv -2i$ at $W = q^i$. Since $DH = 2Y_Q\,h'(X_Q)$ and $D^2H = 4Y_Q^2 h''(X_Q) + 2h'(X_Q)\,w^{(p)\prime}(X_Q)$, multiplying by η_i gives $w^{(p)\prime}(\xi_i) + 4w^{(p)}(\xi_i)\sum_{j\neq i}(\xi_i - \xi_j)^{-1} = -2i\eta_i = \mathcal{D}\xi_i$, which is (R).

For (L), the coefficient of X^{p-1} is $\phi_1 + 6\sigma$, where $\phi_1 = [X^{p-1}]\Phi$ and $\sigma = \sum_i \xi_i$. On the Tate curve Φ/h^2 at $X_Q(W)$ is $X_q(W)$, and $X_q - X_Q \to 0$ as $W \to 1$, so $\phi_1 + 2\sigma = 0$. Summing X_Q over the kernel gives $2\sigma \equiv 2s_1(q) - 1/12$ with $s_1(q) = \sum_{n\geq 1}\sigma_1(n)q^n$, so $\sigma = -E_2/24$. Finally A has weight $p-1$ and q-expansion 1, so $\mathcal{D}A \equiv -E_2/12$, and $\phi_1 + 6\sigma = 4\sigma = -E_2/6 = 2A\,\mathcal{D}A$. □

Theorem 7.5. *For every prime $p \geq 5$ there is $c_S \in \mathbb{F}_p^\times$ with*

$$\mathrm{Res}_x(S_1, \psi_p \bmod p) = c_S\,\Delta_0^{p^2(p^2-1)/24} \quad \text{in } \mathbb{F}_p[a_4, a_6].$$

Hence, by Lemma 7.3, $v_p(\phi_p'(x(T))) = 1$ for every ordinary curve and every T of order p, and $s(\bar{x}) \neq 0$.

Proof. By Proposition 7.4,

$$\mathrm{Res}_x(S_1, \psi_p) = \big(2^{n_p}\mathrm{Res}_X(\mathcal{D}\Psi, \Psi)\big)^p,$$

and $\mathcal{D}\Psi(\xi_i) = -A(\mathcal{D}\xi_i)\prod_{j\neq i}(\xi_i - \xi_j)$. On the Tate curve, $\mathrm{ord}_q(\mathcal{D}\xi_i) = i$ and $\mathrm{ord}_q(\xi_i - \xi_j) = \min(i,j)$, so the resultant has q-order $M = p(p^2-1)/24$, which is one twelfth of its weight. As Δ_0 is the only weight-homogeneous irreducible factor vanishing at the cusp, the resultant is $\gamma_p\Delta_0^M$ with $\gamma_p \neq 0$; the leading coefficients give $\gamma_p = (-1)^{n_p(n_p+1)/2}\,n_p!\,(-16)^M$. □

[Computation: before this proof, the non-degeneracy had been verified for all curves over $\mathbb{F}_p$ with $p \leq 41$.] With $m_K = (p^2-1)(p^2-3)/24$ one also finds $\mathrm{Res}_x(K, \psi_p \bmod p) = \varepsilon_p 2^{m_K}\Delta_0^{m_K}$ with $\varepsilon_p = -1$ exactly when $p \equiv 3 \pmod 8$ [Draft, Prop. 16]; this is not used here.

8. An archimedean threshold

For $Q \in E(\mathbb{Q}) \smallsetminus \{O\}$ let $h(x(Q)) = \log\max(|\alpha(Q)|, d(Q)^2)$.

Lemma 8.1. *If p is a prime of good reduction and $Q \in E_k(\mathbb{Q}_p)$, $k \geq 1$, then $p^k \mid d(Q)$, so $h(x(Q)) \geq 2k\log p$.*

Proof. $Q \in E_k(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ means $v_p(x(Q)) \leq -2k$. □

Proposition 8.2. *Assume* (H) *and that $E(\mathbb{Q})$ is torsion-free, and put*

$$h_{\min} = \min\{h(x(Q)) : 0 \neq Q \in \Lambda \cap E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)\}.$$

If $h_{\min} < 4\log p$, then (χ, γ) is surjective; in rank two Reg_p is then a unit.

Proof. If (χ, γ) is not surjective, its image is the graph of $\gamma = c\chi$, so γ vanishes on $\ker\chi = \Lambda \cap E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$, that is, $\Lambda \cap E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p) \subseteq E_2(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. Lemma 8.1 with $k = 2$ gives $h_{\min} \geq 4\log p$. Then apply Corollary 3.5(i) and [P1, Cor. 6.6]. □

Write the canonical height (normalised so that $\hat{h} \approx h(x)$) as $\hat{h}(Q) = 2v_p(d(Q))\log p + 2\log c' + \lambda'_\infty(Q) + \sum_\ell \mathrm{corr}_\ell(Q)\log\ell$, with $d(Q) = p^{v_p(d)}c'$ and $\mathrm{corr}_\ell \leq 0$ the component corrections [SilH]. Let $m_\infty = \min_{E(\mathbb{R})}\lambda'_\infty$, let m_ℓ be the minimum of corr_ℓ over the components, and put $\beta(E) = m_\infty + \sum_\ell m_\ell\log\ell$.

Proposition 8.3. *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 8.2, if*

$$\hat{h}_{\min} = \min\{\hat{h}(Q) : 0 \neq Q \in \Lambda \cap E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)\} < 4\log p + \beta(E),$$

then (χ, γ) is surjective, and in rank two Reg_p is a unit.

Proof. If (χ,γ) is not surjective, every non-zero $Q \in \Lambda \cap E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ has $v_p(d(Q)) \geq 2$, and the remaining terms are at least $\beta(E)$. □

Lemma 8.4. *Under* (H), $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)/E_2(\mathbb{Q}_p) \cong (\mathbb{Z}/p)^2$, *and* (χ,γ) *fails to be surjective if and only if the image of* Λ *in* $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)/E_2(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ *has order* p. *This depends only on the images of generators of any subgroup of* Λ *of index prime to* p.

Proof. $E(\mathbb{Q}_p) = D \oplus E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ and $E_1/E_2 \cong \mathbb{Z}/p$. The image of Λ has order $p \cdot \#(\text{image of } \Lambda \cap E_1)$, and the second factor is trivial exactly when $\Lambda \cap E_1 \subseteq E_2$. □

[Computation.] Over 3,056 split boxes of rank two from Cremona's tables, Proposition 8.2 accounts for about 68% of the observed deficit in the frequency of $\det(\chi,\gamma) \equiv 0$ relative to $1/p$, and Proposition 8.3 for 100.6% in expectation; on a disjoint set of 5,572 boxes (conductor between 200,000 and 500,000) the figures are 55.8% and 99.7%. No box with $\det(\chi,\gamma) \equiv 0$ lies below the canonical threshold, in these sets or in two further sets of 5,782 and 7,861 boxes outside Cremona's tables (rank-two curves $y^2 = x^3 + Ax + B$ through two small points, or with random small A, B; generators saturated at the primes up to 200, assumed to suffice). Above the threshold the frequency is $1/p$ within the noise on the first two sets; on the last two the non-surjective boxes cluster just above the threshold, for a reason we do not know. The constant m_∞ was computed numerically.

9. Open questions

(1) Is $\det \widehat{C}$ in Corollary 3.5(iii) governed by any local datum? It is a non-degeneracy of the same kind as Schneider's conjecture.
(2) Is the lower bound for $v_p(\mu_{2m})$ in Proposition 5.2 sharp? A sharp bound would determine the earliest digit of every local invariant.
(3) Explain the frequency $1/p$ of $\det(\chi,\gamma) \equiv 0$ above the canonical threshold, and the clustering just above it.

Computation For every anomalous curve over $\mathbb{F}_p$ with $p \leq 157$, the slope ρ of [P1, App. A] satisfies $(\rho/p) = (-3/p)$. Is there a closed form?

Appendix A. Lean formalisation

The Lean project for this paper has 25 files, each importing only Mathlib (Lean 4 `v4.33.1`, Mathlib `0df444a3`), with no `sorry` or `native_decide`; all `#print axioms` lines are subsets of {`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`}. Sources and axiom logs: `https://github.com/yoshikazuhosomura-sys/padic-height-anomalous`, doi:10.5281/zenodo.23856616. Lean checks the arithmetic steps; the p-adic sigma function, division polynomials, formal groups, the Tate curve and local heights enter as hypotheses. For instance, the identity of Lemma 7.3 is a hypothesis of `nd_iff_S_ne_zero`. File k is `PadicHeightValuation`k`.lean`.

Result	Lean declarations	File
Prop. 3.2	`eval_shift_of_deriv_eq`, `fermatQuot2_move`, `lambda2_affine`	11
Lemma 3.1, Thm. 3.4, Cor. 3.5	`eval_shift_first_digit`, `master`, `master_vanish_on_ker_chi`, `det_three_layer`	12
Thm. 4.1, Prop. 4.2	`a1_correction_cancels`, `second_digit_criterion`, `root_factor`, `unique_bad_class`	13
Cor. 4.3	`trichotomy`, `sq_dvd_sub_crit`	14
Cor. 5.5, 6.5	`denominator_third_digit`, `q2_quotient`, `cube_dvd_iff_crit`, `denominator_fourth_digit`, `quartic_dvd_iff_crit`, `quintichotomy`	15, 16
Prop. 6.1	`p_mult_second_digit`, `w_local`, `layer_depth`	16, 23

Thm. 6.2	`shift_depth_exact`, `unit_pow_diff_exact`, `theta_sensitivity_exact`	17
Lemmas 7.1, 7.3	`isogeny_A1_domain`, `isogeny_A2`, `deriv_eval_of_factor`, `nd_iff_S_ne_zero`	18, 20
Prop. 7.4	`residue_iff`, `log_deriv_ratio`, `telescope_sum`	20, 21
Thm. 7.5	`resultant_weight`, `nondegeneracy_summary`	18, 19
Prop. 5.2, 5.3	`mu2_eq`, `mu4_eq`, `mu6_eq`, `mu6_no_b2_cube`, `log_term_factor`, `mu6_visible_at_ten`	22, 23
Prop. 6.3, Thm. 6.4	`ledger_lags`, `ledger_lags_any_m`, `data_count`, `layer_is_needed`, `fermat_digits_needed`	24, 25
Lemma 8.1, Prop. 8.2	`height_ge_of_depth`, `surjective_of_shallow_kernel_element`	27
Prop. 8.3	`surjective_of_canonical_lt_four_log_add_beta`	Can.
Remark after Cor. 6.5	`translate_quadratic`, `ledger_digit`, `inverse_n3`	29

Appendix B. Correspondence with the draft

This paper	[Draft]	This paper	[Draft]
Lemma 3.1	Lemma 7	Prop. 6.1	Props. 12, 19
Prop. 3.2	Props. 9, R′′′′	Thm. 6.2	Thm. G′
Prop. 3.3	Prop. 8	Prop. 6.3	Prop. 20
Thm. 3.4, Cor. 3.5	Thm. K, Cor. K′	Thm. 6.4	Thms. G′′, $G^{(k)}$
Thm. 4.1	Thm. N	Cor. 6.5	Cors. N′′, N′′′
Prop. 4.2	Prop. 10	Lemma 7.1	Lemma 13
Cor. 4.3	Cor. N′	Props. 7.2, 7.4	Props. 14, 15
Thm. 5.1	Thm. N*	Thm. 7.5	Thm. ND, Prop. 16
Prop. 5.2, 5.3	Props. 17, 18	Lemma 8.1	Lemma 23
Lemma 5.4	Lemma 21	Props. 8.2, 8.3	Props. 24, 24^c
Cor. 5.5	Cors. $N^{(3)}$, $N^{(4)}$	Lemma 8.4	Lemma 25

Use of AI

This research was carried out with the assistance of Claude Code (Anthropic). The constructions, proofs, computations and the Lean formalisation were developed with the AI system under the author's direction, and separate sessions of the system re-checked the Lean development and the computations. The author reviewed the arguments, checked the Lean development and its axiom logs, and takes full responsibility for the content.

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